

NEXORA AUTHENTIC PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

Exam: UPSC

Subject: General Knowledge

Questions: 11

Source: Official source PDF extraction

AI-generated PYQs: 0

1. [UNKNOWN] unknown

1. Answer all the following questions in not more than the word limits indicated in the brackets at the end of the questions : 1.(a) Trace the growth of Bhakti movement in South India. (100 words) 10 1.(b) How did the 'mansabdari' system develop as the 'steel frame' of the Mughal empire ? (100 words) 10 1.(c) Describe how in the late nineteenth and early twentieth century people of 'depressed classes' became more assertive under leaders like Jyotiba Phule and Periyar. (200 words) 15 1.(d) How can one explain Gandhi's 'rise to power' ? (200 words) 15

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2. [UNKNOWN] unknown

Q2. Answer all the following questions within the word limits indicated in the brackets at the end of the questions: How does increase in current account deficit of India influence the fall in the value of rupee against the US Dollar ? What remedial measures have been suggested? (200 words) 15 India is going to experience the situation of demographic dividend in the near future, roughly around 2025. Is India capable to reap the benefits of demographic dividend? Give reasons for your answer. (200 words) 15 What is black income ? Examine the recent policy efforts by the Government of India to tackle the problem. (125 words) 10 How do rising oil prices fuel inflation ? What measures would you suggest to contain it in context of the Indian scenario in the recent past? (125 words) 10

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3. [UNKNOWN] unknown

2. Answer all the following questions in not more than 100 words each ; 2.(a) Examine the view that the idea of replacing Planning Commission by National Institution for Transforming India (or 'NITI Aayog') has given a completely new dimension to the process of development planning in the country. 10 2.(b) What are the challenges related to provision of Universal Health Care in India ? 10 2.(c) Examine the policy of 'demonetisation' that the Government of India adopted in November 2016. 10 2.(d) Write a note on recent policies regarding Balance of Payments (BOP) management in India. 10 2.(e) Briefly discuss the major elements of World Trade Organization's (WTO's) 10th Ministerial Conference, 2015, held in Nairobi with particular reference to India. 10 1 fsi-g-gsf ===== PAGE 2 =====

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4. [UNKNOWN] unknown

Q3. Answer all the following questions within the word limits indicated in the brackets at the end of the questions: What do you understand by the term 'Judicial Governance' ? Do you think the judiciary in India has started exercising overarching powers in the name of judicial governance? Comment citing recent examples. (200 words) 15 Communal-Secular debate in Indian polity seems to be dissipating under the ambit of 'Government-Governance' discourse. Comment. (200 words) 15 Though the right to life as enshrined in Part III of the Constitution includes rights to food, shelter and employment, these rights remain non-justiciable. Examine. (125 words) 10 Providing constitutionality to the backward classes will ensure their legitimate empowerment and integration. Give arguments in light of the passage of the recent Constitution (123rd Amendment) Bill for backward classes. (125 words) 10 FSI-G-GSF 2 ===== PAGE 3 =====

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5. [UNKNOWN] unknown

3. Answer all the following questions in not more than 100 words each : 3.(a) What are the significant features of Directive Principles of State Policy? 10 3.(b) What is rule of law ? Explain. 10 3.(c) Do you think National Commission for Scheduled Castes succeeded in protecting Scheduled Caste communities ? Give reasons for your answer. 10 3.(d) Do you perceive development discourse in contemporary India ensures economic democracy? Elaborate. 10 3.(e) Why is that Media is characterised as the Fourth Pillar of Indian Democracy ? 10

6. [UNKNOWN] unknown

Q4. Answer all the following questions within the word limits indicated in the brackets at the end of the questions: Write on the vertical distribution of natural vegetation of Himalayas. (200 words) 15 Discuss the importance of off-shore oil and gas resources for India. (200 words) 15 Examine the economic and strategic importance of the Island regions of India. (125 words) 10 Write on the problematic soils formed due to poor management of irrigation in India. (125 words) 10

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7. [UNKNOWN] unknown

4. Answer all the following questions within the word limits indicated in brackets at the end of the questions : 4.(a) Write the mechanism of landslides. What are the causes of the occurrence of landslides? (150 words) 5+10=15 4.(b) Distinguish between soil erosion and land degradation. How can you control soil erosion? (150 words) 5+10=15 4.(c) "Most of the important hot deserts of the world are located in the tropical region" - Justify this fact. (150 words) 10 4.(d) What are 'geomorphological resources' ? How are geomorphological resources linked with geomorphological hazards? (150 words) 5+5=10

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8. [UNKNOWN] unknown

Q5. Answer all the following questions within the word limits indicated in the brackets at the end of the questions: What are the basis for using micro-organisms in a manufacturing industry ? Describe the various ways in which micro-organisms are involved with the petroleum industry. Also put a brief note on how industrial microbiology has been affected by the new biotechnology (applied genetics) ? (200 words) 15 What are patents ? Briefly describe the various requirements and the process of award of a patent. Discuss the pros and cons of patenting life forms. What is the status of India in this context ? Also write your views on effects of patenting on commercialization of biotechnological products, with justification. (200 words) 15 Why are enzymes important to a cell ? Describe two most striking characteristics of enzymes. Describe three specific types of regulation of enzyme activity. Also differentiate between constitutive and induced enzymes. (100 words) 10 How do garden peas stand up to the requirements for good experimental organisms for genetic breeding? Basically, how does the first division of meiosis differ from mitosis ? (100 words) 10 FSI-G-GSF 3
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9. [UNKNOWN] unknown

5. Answer all the following questions in not more than 100 words each : 5.(a) What are the advantages of organic farming ? 10 5.(b) Describe the uses of 'Neem Coated Urea'. 10 5.(c) What are biodegradable plastics ? 10 5.(d) Explain dryland farming. 10 5.(e) What are biogeographic zones of India ? 10 5.(f) What is 'Mridaparikshak' developed by ICAR ? 10

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10. [UNKNOWN] unknown

Q6. Answer all the following questions within the word limits indicated in the brackets at the end of the questions: (a) Define a "Polymer" and "Degree of Polymerisation". Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of the usage of polymers over metals in modern industries. (200 words) 15 What is Bose-Einstein condensate ? Discuss in brief how the first Bose-Einstein condensate was created. Mention its significance in Modern Physics. (200 words) 15 Write down the full form of the acronym SQUID. Where does one use SQUID ? Mention the important applications of SQUID in medical sciences. (100 words) 10 How does a quantum computer differ from a digital electronic computer ? Mention in brief the working of the quantum computer. (100 words) 10 FSI-G-GSF 4

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11. [UNKNOWN] unknown

6. Answer all the following questions in not more than 100 words : 6.(a) What are the significant uses of drones ? 10 6.(b) What is meant by digital signature ? 10 6.(c) What are gravitational waves ? 10 6.(d) Explain the meaning of 'Robotarium'. 10 fsi-g-gsf

